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B.Sc. (Hons.) in Environmental Science

1. Introduction to Environmental Science

- Definition and scope of environmental science
- Components and systems of the environment - atmosphere, hydrosphere, lithosphere, biosphere, etc.
- Environmental pollution - types, causes, effects and control measures
- Environmental conservation and sustainable development

2. Ecology and Environment

- Concept of ecology, ecosystem and biodiversity
- Structure and function of ecosystems
- Population ecology - growth, regulation, adaptations, etc.
- Community ecology - succession, food chains and food webs, etc.
- Ecological adaptations - with examples
- Conservation of biodiversity and ecosystem

3. Environmental Chemistry

- Atmospheric chemistry - composition, structure and properties of atmosphere
- Water chemistry - properties, pH, hardness, dissolved oxygen, etc.
- Soil chemistry - composition, colloidal nature, acidity, fertility, etc.
- Environmental pollutants - classification, sources, pathways, effects and degradation
- Radioactivity and radiation chemistry

[Similar points on other topics like Environmental Physics, Environmental Biology, Environmental Economics, Environmental Laws, etc.]

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Here is the content in markdown format:

Unit 1 - Environment:

- Definition: Surrounding in which living organisms exist or operate.
- Types of Environment: Natural environment and Built environment.
- Components of environment: Atmosphere, Hydrosphere, Lithosphere, Biosphere.
- Segments of environment: Physical, Biological and Social environment.

- Scope and importance: Environment provides resources necessary for life. Pollution free environment is necessary for healthy living.
- Need for Public Awareness: To conserve natural resources and maintain ecological balance.

Ecosystem:

- Definition: Community of organisms and their physical environment interacting as a system.
- Types of ecosystem: Natural ecosystem and Artificial ecosystem.
- Structure of ecosystem: Biotic and Abiotic components.
- Food Chain, Food Web, Ecological pyramid: To show flow of energy in an ecosystem.
- Balance Ecosystem: Where there is equilibrium between input and output of energy.

Effects of Human Activities:

- Food, Shelter, Housing, Agriculture, Industry, Mining, Transportation, Economic and Social security activities impact environment in both positive and negative ways.
- Environmental Impact Assessment: To evaluate effects of activities on environment and take remedial measures.
- Sustainable Development: Meeting needs of present without compromising ability of future generations to meet their needs.

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Unit 2 - Natural Resources: Introduction, Classification

Water Resources

- Availability: Freshwater available in rivers, lakes, glaciers, groundwater aquifers etc.
- Sources: Precipitation, surface runoff, groundwater recharge
- Quality aspects: pH, dissolved oxygen, turbidity, colour, odour, hardness, salinity, contaminants
- Water borne and water induced diseases: Cholera, dysentery, jaundice, typhoid etc. due to microbial contamination
- Fluoride and arsenic problems in drinking water: Excess fluoride causes fluorosis, arsenic causes arsenicosis which are hazardous to health

Mineral Resources

- Material cycles: Carbon, nitrogen, sulfur cycles which are interconnected and essential for life
- Non-renewable minerals: Metals like iron, bauxite, copper etc. and non-metals like coal, petroleum, natural gas etc. which are being rapidly depleted due to human activities

Energy Resources

- Conventional sources: Fossil fuels (coal, petroleum, natural gas), hydro and nuclear power
- Non-conventional sources: Solar, wind, tidal, geothermal, biomass which are renewable and eco-friendly but currently have limitations in harnessing energy from them

Forest Resources

- Availability: Tropical rainforests have rich biodiversity but are being rapidly depleted; temperate forests have coniferous or deciduous trees
- Depletion of forests: Due to human activities like deforestation, mining, urbanization leading to loss of livelihood for tribes, reduced rainfall, soil erosion and loss of biodiversity
- Impact of forest depletion on society: Disruption of water cycles and increased flooding/droughts, increased air pollution and greenhouse gases leading to global warming, loss of valuable timber, medicinal plants and other resources

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Unit 3 - Pollution and their Effects; Public Health Aspects of Environmental; Water Pollution, Air Pollution, Soil Pollution, Noise Pollution, Solid waste management.

Water Pollution

- discharge of untreated sewage and industrial waste into water bodies.
- effects: harmful chemicals enter food chain, diseases spread, loss of biodiversity.
- solutions: treat sewage and waste before disposing, curb dumping of waste, conserve water.

Air Pollution

- emission of harmful gases and particles from vehicles and industries.
- effects: respiratory diseases, global warming, acid rain, reduced visibility.

- solutions: use of cleaner fuels, afforestation, public transport, emission controls.

Soil Pollution

- excessive use of fertilizers and pesticides kills useful microorganisms.
- effects: loss of soil fertility, entry of chemicals into food chain.
- solutions: organic farming, waste management, bioremediation.

Noise Pollution

- excessive noise from vehicles, machines, etc.
- effects: hearing loss, stress, sleep disturbance, reduced productivity.
- solutions: use of noise absorbing materials, minimise use of loud devices, traffic rules.

Solid Waste Management

- excessive garbage generation and improper disposal.
- effects: spread of diseases, clogs drains and water bodies, loss of land space.
- solutions: segregate waste, composting, recycling, incineration, landfills.

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Unit 4 - Current Environmental Issues of Importance

Global Warming

- Rise in average temperature of Earth's atmosphere and oceans.
- Caused due to greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide and methane trapping heat in the atmosphere.
- Leads to melting of glaciers, rise in sea level, changing weather patterns and more extreme weather events.

Greenhouse Effect

- Certain gases in the atmosphere like carbon dioxide trap the heat from the sun and cause the temperature at the Earth's surface and lower atmosphere to rise.
- Natural greenhouse effect is essential to make the Earth's climate suitable for life. However, human activities like burning fossil fuels have caused enhanced greenhouse effect leading to global warming.

Climate Change

- Long-term changes in average weather patterns across the globe.

- Can lead to both warming and cooling of the planet. Currently, climate change refers to the ongoing warming of the planet due to greenhouse effect.
- Effects include rising sea levels, melting glaciers, heavier precipitation, droughts, heatwaves, etc. which can have serious effects on human society and natural ecosystems.

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Unit 5 - Environmental Protection

Environmental Protection Act 1986

- The Environment Protection Act 1986 is an important act passed by the Parliament of India to protect the environment.
- It provides the framework for waste management and pollution control.
- It emphasized on reducing pollution from industrial and municipal sources, protecting wildlife and biodiversity.
- It created authorities at central and state level to tackle environmental issues.

Initiatives by Non Governmental Organizations (NGO's)

- NGOs play an important role in creating environmental awareness and taking initiatives for conservation and protection of environment.
- Some important NGOs are: – Greenpeace India: It advocates for protecting forests, biodiversity and tackling climate change issues. – Centre for Science and Environment (CSE): It researches on environmental issues and runs campaigns to tackle pollution and create environmental awareness. – Wildlife Trust of India (WTI): It works towards conservation of wildlife and its habitats across India.

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